

/bin

This is the *binary* directory, which contains the executable files. When a program is installed, its binary files are stored here.

/dev

dev stands for “devices.” */dev* contains files that point to the hardware that make up the system. All peripherals are represented as files, and when the service of a device is called for, the file is looked into for the device description and parameters.

/boot

The boot loader files are stored here. Sometimes, an image of the kernel is also maintained in this directory.

/etc

This folder contains various configuration files that can be manually edited to effect system changes. This is a particular feature of Linux by which, knowing what to alter in what files, the user can make almost any change to the system. The files are stored in the .txt format, and can be viewed and modified in any editor.

A crude analogy with Windows is the set of .ini files, and of course, the Registry.

/home

This is the directory that contains the user’s files. Unless otherwise specified, work files will be saved in a user directory that is created for each user in this */home* directory. If a user is created by the name of “*digit*”, then his files will get stored in the “*/home/digit*” folder.

/root

This is the home directory of the root user.

/lib

“Library” files—frequently-used system files needed by programs or the operating system—are stored here, just like the library files stored in “*C:\windows\system*” in Windows operating systems.